

and connect to CSV, text and Excel documents. However, Tableau Public does not allow you to save your workbooks locally.

Tableau Public is a free platform to publicly share and explore data visualisations online. Anyone can create visualisations using either Tableau

Desktop Professional Edition or the free Public Edition. It brings the power of data to everyone across your organisation so that anyone can ask questions and get answers from their data.

Depending upon the choice of product, the software can be downloaded onto the computer and after accepting the licence agreement, you can verify the installation by clicking the Tableau icon.

Getting started

On the *Start* page we can see several options to choose from. This is where you can import your data. As is visible, there are multiple formats that your data can be in. It can be in a flat-file such as Excel, CSV or you can directly load it from data servers too. The first thing that you will obviously need to do is import the data into Tableau. So quickly follow the steps given below.

Since the data is in an Excel file, click on *Excel* and choose the *Sample – Superstore.xls* file you need to get. The *Sample - Superstore* data set comes with Tableau, which contains information about products, sales, profits, and so on. Locate the installation folder of Tableau and go to *My Tableau Repository*. Under it, you will find the above file at *Datasources\9.2\en_US-US*.

1. Drag 'orders' on *Drag sheets here*.
2. Click on 'Use Data Interpreter' to get a clean view and the messy data will disappear.

Click on *Review* the results, and choose the *Orders* tab in the opened Excel sheet to see the changes made.

Data visualisations

We shall be working with a sample data set named *Superstore dataset*, which comes preloaded with Tableau. After importing the data set, next to the *Data Source* tab near the bottom of the screen, click on *Sheet1*. If you are using multiple data sources, you can see them all listed here.

A 'worksheet' is where you make all your graphs; so click on that tab to reach what is displayed in Figure 2.

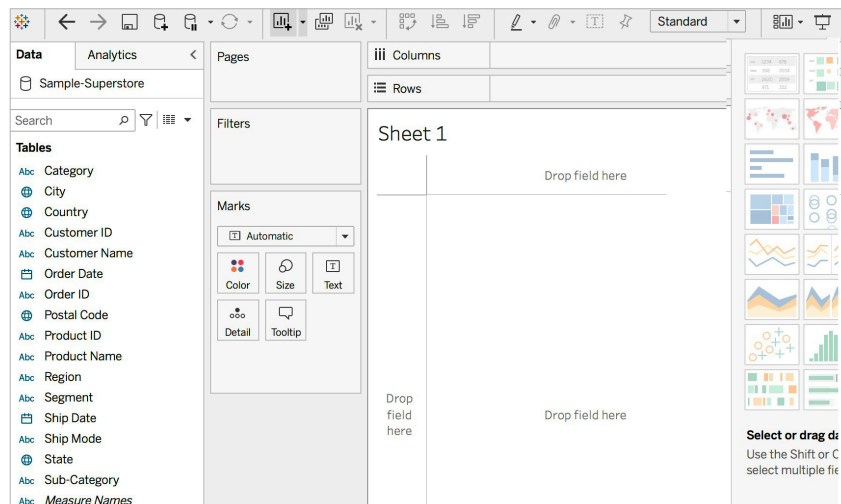


Figure 2: Tableau worksheet

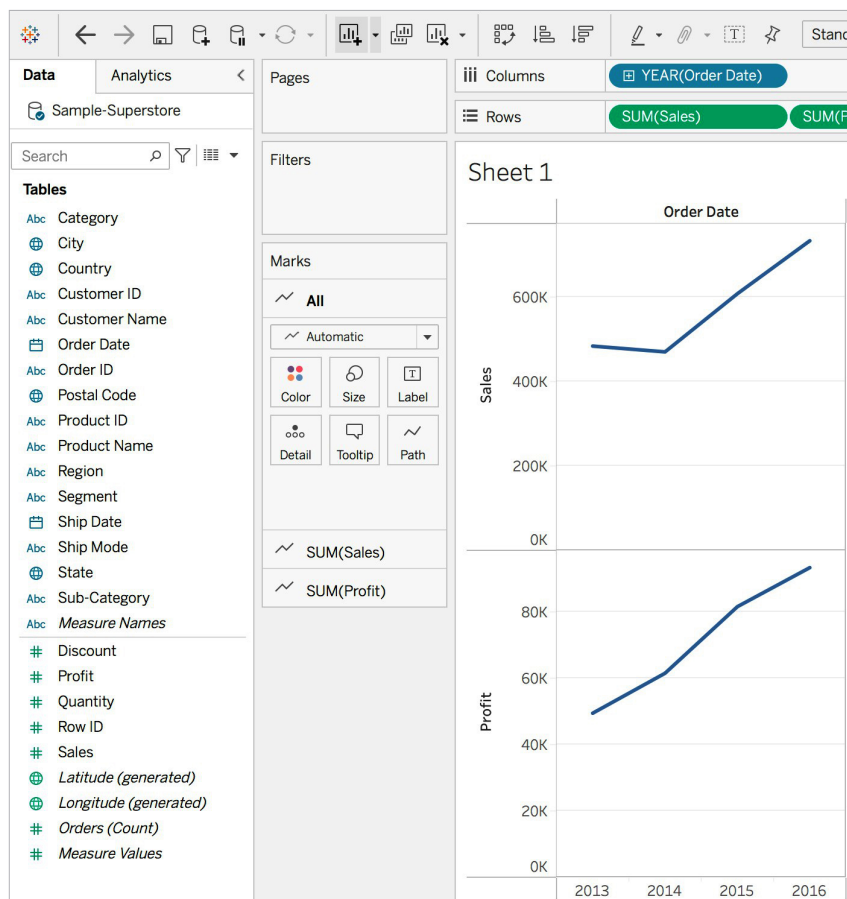


Figure 3: Total aggregated sales and profit